

Filesystem Hierarchy Standard (FHS)

Standardizes linux directories and programs

www.pathname.com/fhs/

Terms

shareable files

can be shared between computers

e.g. user data files, program binary files

un-shareable files

contain system-specific information

e.g. config files

static files

only changed by the system administrator

e.g. program executables

variable files

home directory files

email files

FHS tries to fit all the important directories into a 2x2 matrix

	Shareable	Unshareable
Static	/usr /opt	/etc /boot
Variable	/home /var/mail	/var/run /var/lock

Important Directories and Contents

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/	root directory all directories branch off it
/boot	boot files
/home	user data
/opt	add-on application packages for large third-party software that doesn't follow FHS conventions
/tmp	temporary files
/usr	contains programs divided into subdirectories
	/usr/local software installed locally
/var	variable data logs, mail files etc

<code>/bin</code>	user command binaries <i>cat, cp, kill, ls, mkdir, ps, rm</i>
<code>/dev</code>	device files hardware devices are treated as files
<code>/etc</code>	configuration files
<code>/lib</code>	libraries files shared across many programs
	<code>/lib/modules</code> contains kernel modules (drivers)
<code>/sbin</code>	system admin binaries <i>fdisk, mkswap</i>

Locating Files

find

`find [path] [expression]`

expression

by name	<code>-n pattern</code>	<code>find . -name "*.txt"</code>
by file size	<code>-size [+ -]n</code>	by default n is 512-byte blocks can modify by trailing the value with a letter code e.g. M for megabytes <code>find . -size +10M</code>
by User Id	<code>-uid UID</code>	
by username	<code>-user name</code>	
restrict search depth	<code>-maxdepth levels</code>	limit recursive directories to search

locate

search from a database updated daily

search may not return recently created files

update it manually using `updatedb` which is configured at `/etc/updatedb.conf`

`locate search-string`